

Peptides Unlocked.



Your 48-hour blueprint for safe, evidence-informed therapy — for the reader ready to move past the basics.

A NOTE BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Important Notice.

Read this page first. The rest of the guide assumes you have.

All content in this guide is for educational purposes only — not a substitute for medical advice from your prescribing physician.

This guide is educational. Compounded medications dispensed by Greenstone Rx are prescribed by a licensed physician after review of your health screening. Any decision to start, change, or stop therapy is made between you and the prescribing physician.

Nothing in this guide constitutes a personal medical recommendation. Consult a licensed physician before making any health decisions.

Throughout this volume, language describing dosage ranges, cycle lengths, and protocol design refers to what is commonly reported in published literature — not personal recommendations. Decisions about your own health, including any prescription therapy, belong to you and your physician.

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WELCOME BACK

Continuing the conversation.

If *Peptides Made Easy* taught you the language, *Peptides Unlocked* teaches you the framework.

You already understand that peptides are short amino-acid chains, not steroids. You know that quality matters more than novelty, and that the loudest products online are rarely the most credible. You're past the introduction.

This volume is the next step. Less explaining, more deciding. We've built it for the reader who wants a structured way to think — how to match a goal to a peptide family, how to evaluate a pharmacy in under sixty seconds, how to design a 48-hour starter protocol that actually has a beginning, a middle, and a checkpoint.

Two things to keep in mind as you read.

One: every recommendation here is informational. We describe what the published research community commonly reports — not what you should personally inject, ingest, or attempt. Your physician is the only person qualified to answer that question.

Two: the Greenstone standard is not a marketing line. Third-party Certificates of Analysis, US-shipped logistics, USP 797 sterile compounding, batch-printed traceability — these exist because the alternative is unacceptable. When you finish this guide, you'll know exactly what to look for, whether you start therapy with us or anywhere else.

Clarity beats complexity. Let's build yours.

Onward,

The Greenstone Team

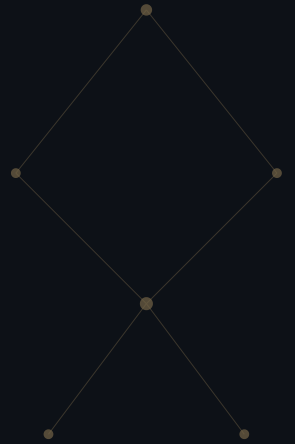
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SECTION ONE · FOUNDATIONS

01

Peptides 101 — stop guessing.

- What peptides actually are at the molecular level — and how they differ from steroids, SARMs, and hormones.
- The five working categories: regenerative, metabolic, performance, cosmetic, immune.
- Why "fast results" is the wrong frame, and what realistic timelines look like in the literature.



SECTION 01 / FOUNDATIONS

Understand what they are (so you stop guessing).

Before any treatment framework matters, the underlying biology has to make sense. Peptides are short chains of amino acids — typically between two and fifty residues — and they sit between single amino acids and full proteins on the size spectrum. In the body, they function as signaling molecules. They bind to receptors and instruct cells: grow, repair, regulate, recover. Think of them as text messages, not loudspeakers.

How peptides differ from steroids, SARMs, and hormones.

The three are routinely confused, and the confusion is expensive. **Steroids** mimic testosterone and act broadly on androgen receptors — broad effect, broad side-effect surface. **SARMs** are synthetic small molecules that bind to specific androgen receptors in muscle and bone. **Hormones** are larger systemic regulators that direct entire organ systems. Peptides are precise: short, targeted, often half-lives measured in minutes to hours. The literature treats them as a fundamentally different class, and so should you.

RESEARCH INSIGHT

Peptide effect is governed by three variables that consistently appear in the literature: receptor binding affinity, half-life, and frequency of administration. Most reported "non-responders" are explained by one of these three before anything else.

The five working categories.

- **Regenerative.** Tissue repair, wound and connective-tissue healing.
- **Metabolic.** Energy regulation, body composition signaling, insulin pathways.
- **Performance & Recovery.** Muscle repair signaling, training adaptation, post-exertion recovery.
- **Cosmetic.** Skin, hair, collagen-adjacent pathways.
- **Immune & Inflammation.** Modulating the body's response to stress and injury.

What you should realistically expect.

Some peptides produce reportable effects in hours; others take weeks of consistent use before any measurable shift. The literature tends to describe early changes in subjective domains (sleep quality, recovery feel) and slower changes in measured domains (body composition, lab values). Diet, sleep, and training never stop mattering — peptides modify a baseline, they do not replace one.

DECISION FRAMEWORK · THE FIVE BEGINNER FAILURE MODES

- Believing in "super-fast" results — the literature rarely supports the timelines marketing implies.
- Ignoring diet, sleep, and exercise — the multiplier effect collapses without them.
- Stacking too many compounds at once — isolating cause and effect becomes impossible.
- Sourcing from unverified vendors — underdosed or mislabeled product produces fake non-response.
- Tracking nothing — without baselines, you cannot know whether anything worked.

The half-life rule of thumb.

When you compare two peptides claiming similar effects, the question to ask is rarely *which is stronger*. The more useful question is *which has a half-life and dosing frequency compatible with the patient's lifestyle*. A compound that requires precise four-times-daily dosing is functionally less effective than a longer-acting alternative for someone with a travel-heavy schedule — not because the molecule is weaker, but because adherence collapses.

RESEARCH INSIGHT

In the published literature, adherence is the most consistent predictor of reported outcome — ahead of dose, ahead of stack design, ahead of subject demographics. Plan for the protocol you will actually follow.

When the underlying biology is clear, the rest of this guide becomes a sequence of decisions rather than guesses. That is the entire point of Volume II.

SECTION TWO · STRATEGY

02

Results first — match goal to peptide family.

- How to pick a single primary outcome and build everything else around it.
- The evidence hierarchy: how to weigh trials, off-label use, case data, and animal models.
- The decision matrix: peptide families across recovery, performance, and longevity goals.



SECTION 02 / STRATEGY

Match the right peptide strategy to your exact goal.

Copy-pasting someone else's protocol is the most common reason patients fail to reproduce reported results. The single most useful exercise in Volume II is the one most readers skip: pick one primary outcome, write it down, and refuse to add a second until the first has a baseline measurement, a four-week observation window, and a documented response.

Pick one primary outcome.

- Fat loss / body composition
- Lean muscle / strength
- Recovery (muscle, joint, connective tissue)
- Injury or tendon support
- Sleep quality
- Libido
- Skin or hair

One goal — not three. Focus is what makes the next four weeks measurable.

The evidence hierarchy.

Not every claim is backed by the same quality of evidence. When the literature is mixed, this is the order to trust:

1. **Human clinical trials (RCTs).** The strongest signal.
2. **Off-label clinical use.** Documented physician use, weaker than RCTs but real-world.
3. **Case studies.** Useful directional clues, not population-level conclusions.
4. **Animal-only studies.** Promising mechanistic data, low translational confidence.

RESEARCH INSIGHT

Stacking two compounds with overlapping pathways is the single fastest way to lose the ability to explain your own results. Start with one. Add only when isolation is no longer possible without it.

The goal → family decision matrix.

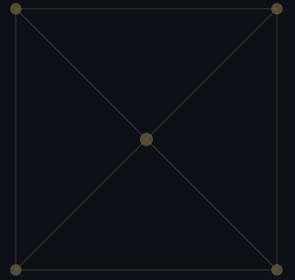
The matrix below maps the most-discussed peptide families across three goal columns. **No dosing is shown.** Dosage decisions belong to a patient and their prescribing physician, not to a guide.

FAMILY	RECOVERY	PERFORMANCE	LONGEVITY
REGENERATIVE	Tissue-repair signalers Most-discussed family for tendon, joint, and connective-tissue recovery research.	Indirect — supports training adaptation by reducing recovery friction between sessions.	Frequently referenced in research on age-related collagen and tissue maintenance.
PERFORMANCE	Lean-mass and strength signaling, common in post-training recovery research.	GH-axis signalers The category most associated with body-composition and strength outcomes.	Mixed signal — literature supports cycling and monitoring rather than continuous use.
METABOLIC	Indirect — better sleep and metabolic signaling improve recovery cascades.	Limited direct performance data; stronger signal for body-composition goals.	Insulin / energy regulators One of the most active research areas in the longevity literature.
COSMETIC	Limited recovery relevance.	Limited performance relevance.	Skin / collagen signalers Active research area for visible-aging biomarkers.
IMMUNE & INFLAMMATION	Strong category for stress-response and chronic-inflammation research.	Indirect — lower systemic inflammation improves training adaptation.	Frequently studied in the context of inflammatory aging mechanisms.

DECISION FRAMEWORK · CONSTRAINT CHECK

- **Budget.** What can you sustain for a full observation window, not just one purchase?
- **Administration preference.** Oral, sublingual, or alternative routes.
- **Travel pattern.** Cold-chain logistics matter more than most patients account for.
- **Existing health context.** Medications, conditions, and physician-flagged interactions.
- **Measurement appetite.** The peptide you can *track* outperforms the one you cannot.

SECTION THREE · SOURCING



03

Quality & legitimacy — the trust signals.

- The five Greenstone trust signals every credible licensed pharmacy should be able to demonstrate.
- How to read a Certificate of Analysis — and how to spot a fake one.
- Storage, cold-chain, and reconstitution principles drawn from the research literature.

SECTION 03 / SOURCING

How to avoid bad products and costly mistakes.

Even the most-cited compound is worthless if the vial is mislabeled, contaminated, or underdosed. Quality is not a preference; it is a precondition. The peptide market has well-documented gray areas — counterfeits, mislabeling, sterility breakdowns — and the only defensible response is a pharmacy checklist applied consistently before any therapy begins.

The Greenstone trust-signal checklist.

**Third-party COA included**

Independent lab, not the seller's own facility.

**US-shipped**

Domestic logistics, no customs ambiguity, predictable cold-chain.

**USP 797 sterile compounding**

ISO Class 5 cleanroom, documented sterile standards, not a marketing line.

**Batch ID printed**

Every vial traceable to a specific lot and a specific COA.

**Consistent reorder identity**

Same product behaves the same way batch over batch.

**Sterile, sealed, cold-pack ship**

Arrival temperature & seal integrity are observable signals.

RESEARCH INSIGHT

If a vendor cannot produce a third-party COA tied to a specific batch number, the conversation ends. Every other trust signal collapses without that single document.

How to read a COA without being fooled.

A Certificate of Analysis should answer four questions on a single page: **what was tested, by whom, on which batch, and against what specification.** If any of those four answers are missing, the document is decorative, not informative. Verify the lab's name independently. Verify the batch number against the vial in your hand. Verify the test date is recent and lot-specific.

DECISION FRAMEWORK · THE COA FOUR-POINT CHECK

- **Identity.** Mass spec confirmation that the compound is what the label claims.
- **Purity.** A reported percentage with a method (HPLC, etc.) and a threshold.
- **Lot & date.** A traceable batch number and a recent issuance date.
- **Lab attribution.** A named, independent laboratory — verifiable on the open web.

Storage, cold-chain, and handling.

Most pharmacy-compounded peptides are temperature-sensitive and degrade quickly under the wrong conditions. The published handling consensus is consistent:

- Reconstitute (when applicable) under clean conditions, with bacteriostatic or sterile water as specified.
- Store cold and out of light. Refrigerate reconstituted product; freeze lyophilized stock if longer shelf life is needed.
- Use within the window the literature describes for that compound — days to weeks, not months, once reconstituted.
- For travel, plan for cold-pack continuity; ambient exposure compounds quickly.

RESEARCH INSIGHT

The most common cause of "this batch didn't work" reports is not a bad batch — it is a degraded one. Cold-chain discipline is part of the therapy, not a footnote to it.

04

Safety screening — before any therapy begins.

- The green / yellow / red screen — how to triage your own context.
- Why a documented physician conversation is the single most important pre-step.
- Conditions, medications, and contexts that the literature flags as "pause first."

SECTION 04 / SAFETY

The green / yellow / red screen.

Every patient framework worth its name begins with a personal context check. The triage below is informational — it is the structure used to decide whether to proceed, to pause, or to stop entirely. None of these categories is a substitute for a conversation with your prescribing physician.

● GREEN**Proceed with structure.**

Generally healthy adult, no flagged medications, established baseline measurements, physician aware.

- Documented baseline labs
- Single-goal protocol
- Tracking system in place
- Stop-criteria defined in writing

● YELLOW**Pause — consult first.**

Mixed signals. Decision is not yours alone — it requires informed clinical input before any therapy begins.

- Existing prescription medications
- Family history flagged by physician
- Previous adverse responses to similar pathways
- Recent surgery or hospitalization

● RED**Do not proceed.**

Conditions and contexts the literature consistently flags as requiring additional evaluation before any prescription therapy begins.

- Active or history of cancer
- Pregnancy or active conception planning
- Uncontrolled cardiovascular conditions
- Under the age of medical majority
- Acute mental-health crisis context

DECISION FRAMEWORK · THE PRE-THERAPY PHYSICIAN CONVERSATION

- Bring the compound name, the published category, and the reported mechanism to your physician.
- Ask specifically about interactions with current medications.
- Establish a baseline lab panel relevant to the chosen goal.
- Document a stop-rule in writing — what observation triggers you halting the therapy.

05

The 48-hour starter protocol framework.

- Hour 0: establish baseline measurements before any therapy begins.
- Hour 24: first journal entry — what changed, what didn't, what surprised you.
- Hour 48: structured review and the first decision point on cycle commonly cited in literature.

SECTION 05 / FRAMEWORK

Design a clear, safe 48-hour starter protocol.

This framework is informational. It does not prescribe a personal protocol. It describes the *structure* commonly used in published literature and treatment journaling. Specific compounds, frequencies, and durations are decisions for you and your prescribing physician.

HOUR 0 · BASELINE

HOUR 24 · FIRST CHECK

HOUR 48 · DECISION



Establish the starting line.

- Record your two-to-four chosen metrics.
- Document baseline labs if applicable.
- Write down your single primary goal.
- Define your stop-rule in advance.
- Confirm sourcing & COA in hand.



First journal entry.

- Sleep quality vs. baseline.
- Subjective energy & mood.
- Any unexpected observation.
- Adherence note — did the plan match reality?
- No protocol change yet. Observe only.



Structured review.

- Re-record baseline metrics.
- Compare to Hour 0.
- Decide: continue, adjust one variable, or pause.
- If adjusting — one change only.
- Schedule the next review window.

RESEARCH INSIGHT

Published literature commonly references cycle lengths in the 4–12 week range, with structured pauses thereafter. This is descriptive, not prescriptive — specific timing belongs to the patient and their prescribing physician.

The supporting structure.

Every treatment framework worth following has a baseline lifestyle layer underneath it. The literature is consistent: outcomes attributed to peptides routinely fail to replicate when the foundation is missing. Common approaches described in the literature include:

- **Sleep.** Seven to nine hours, consistent timing — the single most-cited adherence variable.
- **Protein.** Adequate protein intake, frequently calibrated to lean body mass in the literature.
- **Resistance training.** Even bodyweight progression is enough to produce a usable signal.
- **Hydration & electrolytes.** Underrated; affects subjective measurements significantly.

Measurement, not memory.

Two to four metrics, tracked weekly, beats subjective recall every single time. Common approaches described in the literature include:

- Anthropometric measurements — waist, hip, weight, body composition.
- Goal-relevant labs at fixed intervals.
- Sleep score from a wearable, recorded daily.
- Pain or recovery scale (1–10), recorded morning and evening.
- Training-log numbers — load, reps, perceived exertion.
- Neutral journaling — written observations, dated, with measurements alongside.

DECISION FRAMEWORK · THE ONE-VARIABLE RULE

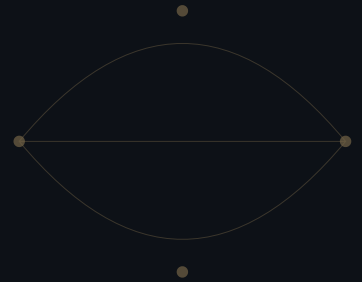
- When you adjust, change one thing. Dose, timing, or supporting habit — one.
- Wait at least one full review window before changing a second variable.
- Document the change. Without documentation, the protocol becomes invisible.
- Patience is not a soft skill in this context — it is the clinical methodology.

A focused, structured plan beats a confusing pile of products every single time.

06

Troubleshooting & optimization.

- The most-discussed reasons patients report "no response" — ranked by frequency.
- The observation → adjustment → pause matrix.
- How research literature describes structured breaks and reassessment cycles.



SECTION 06 / OPTIMIZATION

Get results without escalating risk.

Most "non-response" reports in the clinical community trace back to the same five causes — in this order: wrong compound for the chosen goal, inconsistent adherence, inadequate baseline lifestyle, sourcing failures, and incomplete tracking. Before adjusting any variable inside the protocol itself, work through that list.

The observation matrix.

Each row is informational — framed in educational terms, not as personal directives. Adjustment decisions belong to a patient and their prescribing physician.

OBSERVATION	POSSIBLE ADJUSTMENT DESCRIBED IN LITERATURE	WHEN TO PAUSE
Appetite shifts	Often dose-related in the published literature. Patients and physicians commonly report titrating downward and re-observing across a fresh window.	Persistent > 7 days
Lethargy or fatigue	Frequently a sleep-and-nutrition signal before a compound signal. The literature commonly describes checking the foundation first.	If unrelieved by basics
Water retention / swelling	Often dose-correlated in the literature. Pause and reassess is the most-described approach.	Immediately if marked
Disrupted sleep	Timing shift — the literature commonly describes moving administration earlier in the day.	If > 3 nights
Anxiety or mood change	A category the literature flags as physician-conversation-required, not self-adjustment.	Pause & consult
Plateau (no change)	Most-described first step is auditing the baseline — sleep, nutrition, training — before adjusting anything inside the treatment protocol.	After full window
Diminishing returns	Literature commonly describes cycling off and observing across a wash-out window.	Pause & reassess

RESEARCH INSIGHT

The strongest predictor of long-term reportable progress in the literature is the willingness to pause early. Patients who pause when an observation is ambiguous outperform those who escalate.

When literature describes pausing or cycling off.

Common signals described in the clinical literature as triggers for stepping back:

- New observations the literature flags as concerning.
- No measurable change after a fair observation window with adjusted basics.
- Diminishing returns — signal degrading even as side observations grow.
- Physical or mental fatigue that does not resolve with rest.

Long-term framework.

Published literature consistently describes three habits that separate patients with lasting results from those who cycle without structure:

DECISION FRAMEWORK · THE THREE LONG-TERM HABITS

- **Planned breaks.** Maintenance phases are described in the literature as part of the design, not a failure mode.
- **Regular check-ins.** Lab panels, weight, neutral journaling, training logs — on a schedule, not on a feeling.
- **Continuous learning.** The published literature updates constantly. The serious patient stays current with it.

Volume II's central claim is the same one Volume I started with, refined: the safest framework is, almost without exception, the most effective one over a long enough horizon. Speed is overrated. Compounding adherence is everything.

Slow, measured, documented — that is the operating mode of every patient whose results you would actually trust.

CLOSING FRAMEWORK

Your next three steps.

Volume II is a structure, not a script. The exercise that closes the guide is short on purpose — three actions you can complete this week, before you ever consider sourcing a compound.

01

Pick one goal & three metrics.

Choose your single primary outcome. Choose two-to-four metrics that will measure it. Set up a baseline tracking sheet for the next four-week window. Date everything.

02

Run a safety & quality check.

List any health context that lands in the yellow or red columns of Section 04. Schedule the physician conversation. Write your stop-rule in advance. Confirm your COA & batch ID before purchase.

03

Draft your 48-hour framework.

Document Hour 0, Hour 24, and Hour 48 as the structure of your first observation window. Define what you will measure, when you will pause, and what triggers a one-variable adjustment.

DECISION FRAMEWORK · THE GREENSTONE STANDARD

- **Third-party COA.** On every batch, every order, no exceptions.
- **US-shipped.** Domestic logistics, predictable cold-chain.
- **USP 797 sterile compounding.** ISO Class 5 cleanroom, documented sterile standards.
- **Batch traceability.** Every vial tied to a specific lot and a specific COA.
- **Reorder consistency.** What worked last batch should behave the same in the next.

A CLOSING THOUGHT

"Clarity beats complexity. Safe progress is the fastest progress."

— THE GREENSTONE TEAM

START THERAPY WITH GREENSTONE RX

Use code **RESEARCH15**

Save 15% on your next compounded therapy order. Every batch third-party verified, US-shipped, lot-traceable.

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Greenstone Peptides
PEPTIDE SOLUTIONS

VOLUME II · LEAD MAGNET 02